ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** untouchability	The state can intervene for equality
2	**(d)** political mobilisation on religious lines	A frequent form of communalism
3	**(a)** There is no official religion	All individuals have freedom to profess, practise and propagate any religion
4	**(d)** Pakistan	India's Constitution gives no special status to any religion
5	**(c)** feminist	The term is defined in the chapter
6	**(b)** 54 per cent for women and 76 per cent for men	A smaller proportion of girls go for higher studies
7	**(b)** sex-selective abortion	Parents prefer sons
8	**(a)** special to India	This is the chapter's claim
9	**(c)** No parliamentary constituency has a clear majority of one caste	Hence candidates need support of more than one caste
10	**(b)** Treating followers of all religions as equal citizens	The others are listed in the chapter

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Scheduled Castes (Dalits) were regarded as 'outcaste' and subjected to untouchability (1); Scheduled Tribes (Adivasis) led a secluded life in hills and forests (1).	1+1
12	The number of girl children per thousand boys (1); About 919 as mentioned in the chapter (1).	1+1
13	No constituency has a clear majority of one caste (1); No party wins all the votes of a caste; ruling parties often lose (any one) (1).	1+1
14	A woman or man who believes in equal rights and opportunities for women and men (1); Feminist movements demand equality in political, legal and family life (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	People of one religion do not have the same interests in every context (1); Everyone has several roles and identities (1); There are many voices inside every community (1).	1+1+1
16	Issues related to women's well-being do not get adequate attention (1); Unless women control power their problems will not get attention (1); Reservation of seats is one way to ensure fair representation (1).	1+1+1
17	Average economic status follows the old hierarchy: upper castes best off, Dalits and Adivasis worst (1); Proportion below poverty line is higher among lowest castes (1); Upper castes are over-represented among the rich (1).	1+1+1
	OR: No official religion for the Indian state (1); Freedom to profess, practise and propagate any religion or none (1); Discrimination on grounds of religion is prohibited; state can intervene to ensure equality, as in banning untouchability (1).	1+1+1
18	Most people still marry within their caste or tribe (1); Untouchability has not completely ended (1); Effects of centuries of advantage and disadvantage continue, as upper castes dominate urban middle classes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Parties nominate candidates keeping the caste composition of the electorate in mind (1); Parties make appeals to caste sentiment (1); Governments include representatives of different castes; universal franchise made leaders mobilise support (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	No constituency has a clear majority of one caste (1); No party wins all votes of a caste (1); Several parties may field candidates of the same caste (1); Ruling parties often lose (1); Voters also consider party, performance and economic condition (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: It has given Dalits and OBCs better access to decision making (1); Organisations agitate for dignity and access to land and opportunities (1); Exclusive attention to caste can divert attention from poverty and corruption (1); It can cause tensions and violence (1); Caste politics alone is not healthy for democracy (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Boys and girls are brought up to believe housework is women's main responsibility (1); Women do household work and often paid work as well, but their work is not valued (1); Men do work outside the home and dominate public affairs (1); Women constitute half of humanity but their role in politics is minimal (1); Women's agitations and feminist movements have improved their role (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Some social divisions need to be expressed in politics (1); Women's unequal treatment raised in politics led to gains (1); Disadvantaged groups benefit when divisions become political issues (1); Reservation of seats and equal wage laws came through pressure (1); Not every expression is healthy, as communal politics shows (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying that gender division is **biological**: the chapter stresses that it is based on social expectations and stereotypes, not on biology.
- Mixing up **sexual division of labour** (work split by gender) with 'sex ratio' (number of females per 1000 males).
- Writing that India has an official religion; India is a **secular state**, with no religion given special status.
- Thinking that **communalism** means practising a religion; it means using religion as the basis of politics and treating one's own religion as superior.
- Claiming that caste alone decides how people vote; the chapter shows that **caste is only one factor** and voters also consider party and performance.
- Believing that caste has disappeared with urbanisation; caste inequality continues, though it has weakened, and **caste in politics** can help as well as harm.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** bringing caste identities into the political arena	Caste gets politicised
2	**(b)** sexual division of labour	It keeps women away from public life
3	**(c)** hereditary occupational division sanctioned by rituals	Members married within the caste and did not eat with others
4	**(a)** a large proportion of voters of that caste vote for one party	No party wins all votes of a caste
5	**(a)** Jotiba Phule	Others are Gandhiji, Ambedkar and Periyar Ramaswami Naicker
6	**(a)** Sweden	Scandinavian countries such as Sweden, Norway and Finland
7	**(c)** religion is the principal basis of social community	This belief is flawed
8	**(d)** social expectations and stereotypes	The chapter says it is not based on biology
9	**(a)** about one hour more per day than an average man	Much of her work is unpaid and invisible
10	**(a)** 919 girls per thousand boys	It fell below 850 or even 800 in some States

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A system that values men more and gives them power over women (1); Literally, rule by the father (1).	1+1
12	All work inside the home is done by women or organised by them through domestic helpers (1); Men do the work outside the home (1).	1+1
13	Much of it is household work that is unpaid (1); It is not seen as income generating work (1).	1+1
14	There is no official religion (1); Freedom to profess, practise and propagate any religion; ban on religious discrimination (any one) (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Caste groups try to become bigger by including neighbouring castes (1); Castes enter into coalitions with other castes and communities (1); New groups like 'backward' and 'forward' castes come up (1).	1+1+1
16	Women agitated for voting rights and equal legal and political status (1); They demanded better education and career opportunities (1); Women now work as scientists, doctors, engineers and managers (1).	1+1+1
17	No constituency has a clear majority of a single caste (1); No party wins the votes of all voters of a caste (1); Ruling parties often lose, and voters attach importance to performance, party and economic condition (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Prejudices and propaganda exist in everyday life (1); Religion-based mobilisation occurs in politics (1); These need to be countered by people in daily life and in politics (1).	1+1+1
18	Literacy rate among women is lower than among men and fewer girls go for higher studies (1); Women are paid less than men for equal work (1); Sex-selective abortion has lowered the child sex ratio; there is harassment and domestic violence (1).	1+1+1
	OR: When one religion is presented as superior to others (1); When demands of one group are formed in opposition to another (1); When state power is used to establish dominance of one group (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Belief that religion is the principal basis of social community (1); Everyday beliefs and stereotypes (1); Quest for political dominance (1); Political mobilisation on religious lines (1); Communal violence and riots (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: No official religion (1); Freedom to profess, practise and propagate any religion (1); No discrimination on grounds of religion (1); State can intervene to ensure equality, such as banning untouchability (1); Secularism is a foundation of the country (1).	1+1+1+1+1

20	Changes: urbanisation, education, occupational mobility, weakening of landlords (1); Constitution prohibits caste discrimination (1); Persistence: marriage within caste, untouchability continues (1); Upper castes dominate urban middle class (1); Caste is linked to economic status (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Hindus 79.8 per cent, Muslims 14.2 per cent, Christians 2.3 per cent, Sikhs 1.7 per cent (1); Buddhists 0.7 per cent and Jains 0.4 per cent (1); SC 16.6 per cent and ST 8.6 per cent in 2011 (1); OBC about 41 per cent by NSS 2004-05 (1); Proportions of religions have not changed much (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying that gender division is **biological**: the chapter stresses that it is based on social expectations and stereotypes, not on biology.
- Mixing up **sexual division of labour** (work split by gender) with 'sex ratio' (number of females per 1000 males).
- Writing that India has an official religion; India is a **secular state**, with no religion given special status.
- Thinking that **communalism** means practising a religion; it means using religion as the basis of politics and treating one's own religion as superior.
- Claiming that caste alone decides how people vote; the chapter shows that **caste is only one factor** and voters also consider party and performance.
- Believing that caste has disappeared with urbanisation; caste inequality continues, though it has weakened, and **caste in politics** can help as well as harm.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** communal violence, riots and massacre	India and Pakistan saw this at the time of Partition
2	**(b)** Urbanisation and growth of literacy	Also occupational mobility
3	**(b)** Scheduled Tribes	Data from NSSO 1999-2000
4	**(a)** 33 per cent reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies	It also covers the Delhi Assembly
5	**(d)** Dalits	Previously regarded as 'outcaste' groups
6	**(d)** equal wages should be paid for equal work	Yet women are paid less in many areas
7	**(d)** 2019	The share in State Assemblies is less than 5 per cent
8	**(a)** secular state	To face the challenge of communalism
9	**(c)** patriarchy	Literally, rule by the father
10	**(b)** moral values that inform all religions	He believed politics must be guided by ethics

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A system of hereditary occupational division sanctioned by rituals (1); Members married within the caste and did not eat with others (1).	1+1
12	Politics that treats religion as the principal basis of social community (1); It pits followers of one religion against another (1).	1+1
13	Everyday religious prejudices and stereotypes (1); Political mobilisation on religious lines, or communal violence (any one) (1).	1+1
14	The share reached 14.36 per cent in 2019 (1); It is below 5 per cent in State Assemblies (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Urbanisation, literacy, occupational mobility and weakened landlords have broken down old notions of hierarchy (1); Constitution prohibits caste discrimination (1); Rich and poor are found in every caste (1).	1+1+1
16	Women work a little over seven and a half hours a day and men about six and a half hours (1); Men's work is mostly income generating and visible (1); Women's work is mostly household work, which is unpaid and invisible (1).	1+1+1
17	Everyday beliefs: prejudice and stereotypes (1); Quest for dominance: majoritarianism or separate political unit (1); Mobilisation on religious lines and communal violence like riots at Partition (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Positive: gives disadvantaged communities space to demand their share of power (1); Helped Dalits and OBCs gain access to decision making (1); Negative: can divert attention from poverty, development and corruption, and lead to conflict (1).	1+1+1
18	He did not mean any particular religion (1); He meant moral values common to all religions (1); He believed politics must be guided by ethics drawn from religion (1).	1+1+1
	OR: One-third seats reserved for women in panchayats and municipalities (1); More than 10 lakh women representatives in local bodies (1); Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023 gives 33 per cent in Lok Sabha and State Assemblies (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Candidates are chosen considering caste composition (1); Appeals to caste sentiment and favouring of castes by parties (1); Universal adult franchise forced leaders to mobilise support (1); Caste groups enlarge and form coalitions (1); New caste groups, backward and forward, appear (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Women's problems get attention only when women have power (1); Legal reservation of one-third seats in local bodies (1); Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam gives 33 per cent in Lok Sabha and Assemblies (1); Women's organisations demanded this for decades (1); More women representatives bring greater voice (1).	1+1+1+1+1

20	Literacy 54 per cent for women and 76 per cent for men (1); Women paid less than men for the same work despite the 1976 Act (1); Sex-selective abortion reduced child sex ratio to 919 (1); Harassment and domestic violence (1); Women are 14.36 per cent in the Lok Sabha and less than 5 per cent in State Assemblies (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: It threatens the very idea of India (1); It treats religion as the only basis of community (1); Secular Constitution is needed but not enough (1); Prejudice and propaganda must be countered in everyday life (1); Religion-based mobilisation should be countered in politics (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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